Magic rule – Dying and being raised · SRD 5.2.1

When a character dies (three failed death saves, instant death), they aren't always lost: spells like *Revivify*, *Raise Dead* or *Resurrection* bring them back, provided you act **fast enough** and pay the **component cost**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Revivify**: dead for less than **1 minute**.
2. **Raise Dead**: up to **10 days**, **1 HP**.
3. **Resurrection**: up to **100 years**, full HP.
4. Each spell needs a **costly component**.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps the same spell ladder. A raised character receives **d20 penalties** that fade with Long Rests.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say whether the soul must be willing or what to do with a destroyed body. Fix: these cases are up to the DM; only *True Resurrection* or *Wish* handles a destroyed body.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can play the return: lingering cold, hazy memories, a debt to the divine.

Step 1 – Death:

The character is dead (3 failures, instant death…). See the HP, healing and death sheet.

Step 2 – Time limit:

Count the time since death: 1 minute, 10 days, 100 years…

Step 3 – Pick the spell:

Revivify (lvl 3), Raise Dead (lvl 5), Reincarnate (lvl 5), Resurrection (lvl 7), True Resurrection (lvl 9).

Step 4 – Pay:

Diamond or rare oils: 300, 500, 1,000, 25,000 gp depending on the spell.

Step 5 – Return:

The character returns with **1 HP** (lower spells) or **full HP** (higher spells), with a recovery penalty.

Example: Bryn dies. After 30 seconds, Mira casts Revivify (300 gp diamond): Bryn returns with 1 HP.

Spell	Lvl	Max. time	Cost	Return
Revivify	3	1 minute	300 gp diamond	1 HP
Raise Dead	5	10 days	500 gp diamond	1 HP
Reincarnate	5	10 days	1,000 gp oils	New form
Resurrection	7	100 years	1,000 gp diamond	Full HP
True Resurrection	9	200 years	25,000 gp diamonds	Full HP

⚠ Common questions:

Which spell for a recent death?
Revivify, within the minute.

How long for Raise Dead?
Up to 10 days.

What does Resurrection cost?
A 1,000 gp diamond.

How many HP on return?
1 HP, or full HP depending on the spell.

A destroyed body?
Only True Resurrection or Wish.

Died of old age?
All spells except Revivify.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Willing soul
Can the dead refuse? **Option**: yes, the DM decides.

Component cost
Is the diamond consumed? **Option**: yes, always.

No penalty return
Can the penalty be removed? **Option**: one Long Rest.

Repeated raising
How many times? **Option**: once per campaign.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Penalties
On d20 rolls, fading after Long Rests.

Destroyed body
Only the highest spells repair it.

Death vs final death
See the HP, healing and death sheet.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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